

2 CHRONICLES XVIII.

4 And Jehoshaphat said unto the king of Israel, Inquire, I pray thee, to-day (first) of the word of the LORD.

5 Then did the king of Israel assemble the prophets, four hundred men, and said unto them, Shall we go to Ramoth-gil'ad to battle, or shall I forbear? And they said, Go up, and God will deliver (it) into the hand of the king.

6 And Jehoshaphat said, Is there not here a prophet of the Eternal besides, that we might inquire of him?

7 And the king of Israel said unto Jehoshaphat, There is yet one man, by whom we may inquire of the LORD; but I hate him; for he never prophesieth any good concerning me, but at all times evil: it is Michayhu the son of Yimla. And Jehoshaphat said, Let not the king say so.

8 Then called the king of Israel a certain court-officer, and said, "Hasten hither Michayhu the son of Yimla."

9 And the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat the king of Judah were sitting each on his throne, dressed in their royal garments, and they were sitting in a threshing-floor at the entrance of the gate of Samaria: and all the prophets prophesied before them.

10 And Zedekiah the son of Kena'anah had made himself horns of iron; and he said, Thus hath said the LORD, With these shalt thou push the Syrians until thou have made an end of them.

11 And all the prophets prophesied so, saying, Go up against Ramoth-gil'ad, and prosper, and the LORD will deliver it into the king's hand.

12 And the messenger that went to call Michayhu spoke to him, saying, Behold, the words of the prophets are with one voice good for the king: so do let thy word, I pray thee, be like (that of) any one of them, and speak something good.

13 And Michayhu said, As the LORD liveth, truly what my God may say, that will I speak.

14 And when he was come to the king, the king said unto him, Michah, shall we go to Ramoth-gil'ad to battle, or shall I forbear? And he said, Go ye up, and prosper, and may they be delivered into your hand.

15 And the king said to him, How many times yet must I adjure thee that thou shalt not speak to me any thing but the truth in the name of the LORD?

16 Then said he, I saw all Israel scattered over the mountains, as flocks that have not a shepherd: and the LORD said, These have no master; let them return every man to his house in peace.

17 And the king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, Did I not say unto thee that he would not prophesy concerning me any good, but (only) for evil?

18 ¶ And he said, Therefore hear ye the word of the LORD: I saw the LORD sitting on his throne, and all the host of heaven standing on his right and his left.

19 And the LORD said, Who will persuade Achab the king of Israel, that he may go up and fall at Ramoth-gil'ad? And one said—one saying after this manner, and another saying after that manner.

20 Then came there forth a spirit, and placed himself before the LORD, and said, I will persuade him. And the LORD said unto him, Wherewith?

21 And he said, I will go forth, and I will become a lying spirit in the mouth of all his prophets. And he said, Thou wilt persuade him, and also prevail: go forth, and do so.

22 And now, behold, the LORD hath put a lying spirit in the mouth of these thy prophets; but the LORD hath spoken evil concerning thee.

23 And Zedekiah the son of Kena'anah went near, and struck Michayhu on the cheek, and said, Which is the way the Spirit of the LORD passed away from me to speak with thee?

24 And Michayhu said, Behold, thou shalt see it on that day when thou shalt go into the innermost chamber to hide thyself.

25 And the king of Israel said, Take ye Michayhu, and carry him back unto Amon the governor of the city, and to Joash the king's son;

26 And say ye, Thus hath said the king, Put this man in the prison, and feed him with sparing bread and with sparing water, until I return in peace.

27 And Michayhu said, If thou return at all in peace, then hath the LORD not spoken through me. And he said, Hear it, O all ye nations!

28 ¶ And the king of Israel went up with Jehoshaphat the king of Judah to Ramoth-gil'ad.

2 CHRONICLES XVIII. XIX. XX.

29 And the king of Israel said unto Jehoshaphat, I will disguise myself, and enter into the battle; but do thou put on thy royal garments. And the king of Israel disguised himself, and they went into the battle.

30 And the king of Syria had commanded the captains of the chariots that he had, saying, Fight ye not with the small or with the great, save only with the king of Israel alone.

31 And it came to pass, when the captains of the chariots saw Jehoshaphat, that they said, This is the king of Israel. And they encompassed him to fight; and Jehoshaphat cried out, and the LORD helped him; and God induced them to go away from him.

32 And it came to pass, when the captains of the chariots perceived that it was not the king of Israel, that they turned back from following him.

33 But a certain man drew his bow at a venture, and struck the king of Israel between the joints and the armour: wherefore he said to the chariot-driver, Turn about, and carry me out of the camp; for I am wounded.

34 And the battle increased on that day: and the king of Israel stayed (himself) up in the chariot against the Syrians until the evening, and he died at the time of the sun's going down.

CHAPTER XIX.

1 ¶ And Jehoshaphat the king of Judah returned to his house in peace, to Jerusalem.

2 And there came out to meet him Jehu the son of Chanani the seer, and said to king Jehoshaphat, Shouldst thou help the wicked, and love those that hate the LORD? and because of this there is wrath over thee from before the LORD.

3 Nevertheless there are good things found on thee; because thou hast removed the Asheroth out of the land, and hast directed thy heart firmly to seek God.

4 ¶ And Jehoshaphat remained at Jerusalem; but he went out again through the people from Beër-sheba' as far as the mountain of Ephraim, and caused them to return unto the LORD the God of their fathers.

5 And he appointed judges in the land in all the fortified cities of Judah, in city by city.

6 And he said to the judges, Look (well)

at what ye are doing; because not for man are ye to judge, but for the LORD, who is with you in pronouncing judgment.

7 And now let the dread of the LORD be upon you: take heed and act; for with the LORD our God there is no injustice, nor respect for persons, nor taking of bribes.

8 But also in Jerusalem did Jehoshaphat appoint some of the Levites, and the priests, and of the chiefs of the family divisions of Israel, for the (giving of) the judgment of the LORD, and for controversies, when they returned to Jerusalem.

9 And he charged on them, saying, Thus shall ye do in the fear of the LORD, in faithfulness, and with an undivided heart.

10 And whatsoever controversy may come to you from your brethren that dwell in their cities, between blood and blood, between law and commandment, statutes and ordinances, ye shall truly warn them that they incur not guilt against the LORD, and so there come wrath over you, and over your brethren: so must ye do, and ye will not incur guilt.

11 And, behold, Amaryahu the chief priest is over you for every matter of the LORD; and Zebadyahu the son of Yishma'el, the ruler for the house of Judah, for every matter of the king; and the Levites are officers before you. Be strong and act, and may the LORD be with the good.

CHAPTER XX.

1 ¶ And it came to pass after this, that the children of Mo'ab, and the children of 'Ammon, and with them some of the 'Ammonim,* came against Jehoshaphat to battle.

2 And there came some and told unto Jehoshaphat, saying, There is coming against thee a great multitude from beyond the sea, from Syria; and, behold, they are in Chazon-thamar, which is 'En-gedi.

3 Then became Jehoshaphat afraid, and he directed his face to seek the LORD; and he proclaimed a fast over all Judah.

4 And (the people of) Judah gathered themselves together, to ask (help) of the LORD: also out of all the cities of Judah did they come to seek the LORD.

* Some suppose this to mean "the Me'unim," the inhabitants of Arabia Petraea.

2 CHRONICLES XX.

5 And Jehoshaphat stood forward in the assembly of Judah and Jerusalem, in the house of the LORD, before the new court,

6 And he said, O LORD, the God of our fathers, behold, thou art God in the heavens, and thou rulest over all the kingdoms of the nations; and in thy hand are the power and might, and there is none that can withstand thee.

7 Behold, it is thou, O our God, who hast driven out the inhabitants of this land from before thy people Israel; and thou gavest it to the seed of Abraham thy friend to eternity.

8 And they have dwelt therein, and have built for thee therein a sanctuary for thy name, saying,

9 If there should come over us any evil, the sword, punishment, or pestilence, or famine, (then) will we stand before this house, and in thy presence, for thy name is in this house, and we will cry unto thee out of our distress, and thou wilt hear and help.

10 And now, behold, the children of 'Ammon and Moâb and mount Se'ir, against whom thou wouldst not suffer Israel to come, when they came out of the land of Egypt, but they turned aside from them, and destroyed them not:—

11 And behold, they recompense us, by coming to drive us out of thy inheritance, which thou hast given us to possess.

12 O our God, wilt thou not execute justice on them? for there is no power in us against this great multitude that is coming against us; and we indeed know not what we are to do; but upon thee are our eyes (directed).

13 And all Judah were standing before the LORD, also their little ones, their wives, and their sons.

14 And upon Jachaziël the son of Zecharyahu, the son of Benayah, the son of Je'iel, the son of Matthanyah, the Levite, of the sons of Assaph, came the spirit of the LORD in the midst of the assembly;

15 And he said, Listen ye, all Judah, and ye inhabitants of Jerusalem, and thou king Jehoshaphat, Thus hath said the LORD unto you, Be ye not afraid and be not dismayed because of this great multitude; for not unto you belongeth the battle, but unto God.

16 To-morrow go ye down against them:

behold, they come up by the ascent of Ziz; and ye will find them at the end of the valley, in front of the wilderness of Jeruël.

17 Ye shall not need to fight in this place: stand firmly, stand still, and see the salvation of the LORD with you, O Judah and Jerusalem: fear not, and be not dismayed; to-morrow go out to meet them, and the LORD will be with you.

18 And Jehoshaphat bowed his head with his face to the ground: and all Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem fell down before the LORD, to prostrate themselves unto the LORD.

19 And then arose the Levites, of the children of the Kehathites, and of the children of the Korchites, to praise the LORD the God of Israel with a very loud voice.

20 And they rose up early in the morning, and went forth into the wilderness of Thekoî: and as they went forth, Jehoshaphat stood forward and said, Hear me, O Judah, and ye inhabitants of Jerusalem; believe in the LORD your God, and ye will have permanence; believe his prophets, and ye will prosper.

21 And he consulted with his people, and he appointed singers unto the LORD, and those that should praise in the holy ornaments, as they went out before the armed array, and said, Give thanks unto the LORD; for unto everlasting endureth his kindness.

22 And at the time when they began with the song and the praise, the LORD set an ambush against the children of 'Ammon, Moâb, and mount Se'ir, who were come against Judah, and they were smitten.

23 And the children of 'Ammon and Moâb stood up against the inhabitants of mount Se'ir, utterly to annihilate and to destroy them; and when they had made an end of the inhabitants of Se'ir, they helped to destroy one another.

24 And when Judah came toward the watchtower in the wilderness, they looked toward the multitude, and, behold, they were dead bodies fallen to the earth, and none had escaped.

25 And then came Jehoshaphat and his people to plunder their booty; and they found among them in abundance both riches and dead bodies, and costly vessels, which they stripped off for themselves, more than they could carry away: and they were three